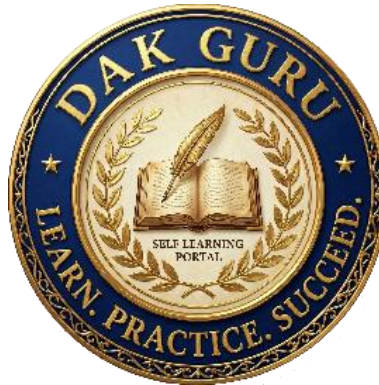

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POSTAL MANUAL

VOLUME V

Railway Mail Service • Mail Operations • Bagging & Conveyance

Comprehensive Study Material for Departmental Examinations

LDCE — Inspector of Posts | PS Group 'B' | PA / SA | IPO

Updated as per the Post Office Act, 2023 and the Post Office Rules & Regulations, 2024

Disclaimer

This booklet has been prepared strictly from an examination point of view. While every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and to incorporate the most recent changes, amendments, orders, circulars and notifications relating to the relevant Acts, Rules and Regulations, this document is intended as a study aid only.

*The Postal Manual Volume V is a departmental compilation that continues to operate as administrative practice. With effect from 18 June 2024, the **Post Office Act, 2023** has replaced the Indian Post Office Act, 1898, and with effect from 16 December 2024 the **Post Office Rules, 2024** and **Post Office Regulations, 2024** have superseded the Indian Post Office Rules, 1933. Existing departmental rules and orders continue in force only to the extent they are not inconsistent with the new law.*

Readers and aspirants are strongly advised to refer to official Government sources, the Gazette of India, and the latest Directorate circulars for the most authoritative and up-to-date position before relying on any provision for service or examination purposes. Dak Guru and DG InfoTech accept no liability for any consequence arising from the use of this material.

About this Edition

This is a **verified and enhanced edition** of the Postal Manual Volume V notes. Every statutory figure, rule reference, monetary limit and structural fact in this booklet has been cross-checked against primary and official sources current as on **June 2026**. Where a provision of the old framework has been overtaken by the Post Office Act, 2023 or the Post Office Rules / Regulations, 2024, a **Currency Update** box flags the change so that the reader is never left with an outdated provision presented as current.

Key sources relied upon include: the Post Office Act, 2023 (Act 43 of 2023); the Post Office Rules, 2024 (G.S.R. 767(E), 16.12.2024); the Post Office Regulations, 2024 (S.O. 5440(E), 16.12.2024); the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023; relevant Directorate orders on investigation limits and RLO rationalisation; and the parent text of Postal Manual Volume V.

How to Use This Booklet

The notes follow the structure and rule-numbering of the Postal Manual Volume V so that you can map every point back to its source rule. Three types of coloured boxes appear throughout; learning to read them quickly will save you time in the examination hall:

LEGISLATIVE NOTE

Explains the statutory basis of a rule — the Act, Rule or Gazette notification behind it. Read these to understand the legal authority for a provision.

CURRENCY UPDATE

Flags a point where the position has changed under recent law, orders or circulars. This is the most exam-critical box: it tells you what is the current, correct answer and what has become outdated.

NOTE / MEMORY AID

Highlights a definition, distinction or number that is frequently tested, or gives a quick aid to remember an easily-confused point.

Exam tip: In objective papers, the examiner usually targets **numbers** (weights, limits, fees, time-frames), **colour codes**, **designations / in-charge**, and **definitions**. These are presented in tables and bold text throughout for rapid revision.

The New Legislative Framework (Read First)

Before studying the operational rules, every aspirant must understand the single biggest change to postal law in 125 years. The colonial-era statute and its rules have been replaced by a new, simplified framework. The Postal Manual Volume V, however, has **not** been withdrawn — it continues to govern day-to-day operations as administrative practice, except where a specific provision conflicts with the new law.

LEGISLATIVE NOTE — The Three Pillars of the New Framework

1. **Post Office Act, 2023** (Act 43 of 2023) — received Presidential assent on 24.12.2023 and came into force **with effect from 18 June 2024**. It repealed the Indian Post Office Act, 1898. It has only 16 sections (the old Act had 77) and removes all the old penalties and offences.
2. **Post Office Rules, 2024** (G.S.R. 767(E)) — came into force **with effect from 16 December 2024**, in supersession of the Indian Post Office Rules, 1933. Contains 19 rules.
3. **Post Office Regulations, 2024** (S.O. 5440(E)) — also in force **from 16 December 2024**. Contains 180 regulations covering the operational detail of every product and service.

The Saving Clause — Why Postal Manual Vol V Still Matters

Section 16(2) of the Post Office Act, 2023 contains a **saving provision**: notwithstanding the repeal of the 1898 Act, all rules, notifications and orders made under the old Act **continue in force** — in so far as they relate to matters provided for in the new Act and are not inconsistent with it — until they are superseded. This is precisely why the Postal Manual Volume V remains the working reference for RMS and mail operations. The new Rules and Regulations are deliberately high-level; the procedural detail still lives in the Manual.

Quick Map: Old vs New

Subject	Old Position	Current Position (in force)
Parent Act	Indian Post Office Act, 1898	Post Office Act, 2023 (w.e.f. 18.06.2024)
Subordinate Rules	Indian Post Office Rules, 1933	Post Office Rules, 2024 (w.e.f. 16.12.2024)

Subject	Old Position	Current Position (in force)
Operational detail	Spread across Rules + Manuals	Post Office Regulations, 2024 + Manuals
Criminal procedure cited	CrPC, 1973	Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023 (w.e.f. 01.07.2024)
Penalties / offences	Many (Sections 49, 52 etc.)	Abolished; dues recoverable as land-revenue arrears
Exclusive privilege on letters	Government monopoly (Sec. 4)	Abolished; private couriers recognised
Manual Vol V status	Primary working reference	Continues as administrative practice (saving clause)

Exam Watch

If a question asks 'under which Act is the Post Office governed today?', the answer is the Post Office Act, 2023 — not the 1898 Act. But if it asks about a detailed RMS procedure, the Postal Manual Vol V remains correct because of the saving clause.

Chapter 1 — Organisational Definitions and Structure

This chapter defines the building blocks of the Railway Mail Service (RMS) and the network of offices through which mail flows. The rule numbers follow the Postal Manual Volume V. Pay close attention to the **in-charge designations** and **office abbreviations** — these are among the most frequently examined points.

Rule 2 — Railway Mail Service (RMS)

The expression “*Railway Mail Service*” refers to the service responsible for the carriage of mails by **rail, road, river and air**, and for the collection and distribution of mails received from Post Offices by Mail Offices and Sections.

MEMORY AID

Despite the word “Railway”, the RMS carries mail by all four modes — rail, road, river and air. The name is historical; the function is multi-modal.

Rule 5-A — V-SAT Stations

Important Head Post Offices are identified as **Very Small Aperture Terminal (V-SAT) Stations**. Money orders are transmitted from these Post Offices using V-SAT (satellite) technology.

Rule 5-B — Extended Satellite Money Order (ESMO)

These stations function as extension counters for the booking and transmission of money orders through V-SAT stations.

Rule 5-C — Hybrid Mail Service

This service involves the **electronic transmission** of written material from one place to another using computer terminals connected through VSAT. The material can then be printed and delivered to one or more addressees at the receiving station — bridging the electronic and physical mail streams.

CURRENCY UPDATE

V-SAT/ESMO and the early Hybrid Mail concept reflect the technology of an earlier era. In current practice, electronic money remittance is handled through the Electronic Money Order (eMO) / Instant Money Order ecosystem on the CSI platform, and the Money Order ceiling

has been revised to ₹10,000 under the Post Office Regulations, 2024. The Manual rule is retained for completeness, but the operative remittance limits are now those notified under the 2024 Regulations.

Rule 9-A — Transit Office

A **Transit Office** is any Post Office situated on a line of through mail communication that receives and sorts bags intended for offices in advance, **without opening them**.

- **Forward Bags:** Bags forwarded onwards unopened are termed “forward bags”.
- **Procedure:** Transit bags addressed to a transit office are opened there. The forward bags contained within are sent onwards, either loose or enclosed in other transit bags.
- **Purpose:** The use of a transit office is to reduce the number of loose bags in the system.

Rule 9-B — Transit Mail Office (TMO)

A **Transit Mail Office (TMO)** is a branch of the RMS where closed bags are received and dispatched.

- **Function:** Sorting of letters is **not** done in this unit.
- **In-Charge:** A Mail Agent or Mail Guard is in charge of this unit.
- **Sets:** This office can function in a number of sets depending upon requirements. For example: Delhi TMO Set No. 1 works 06:00–14:00 hours; Delhi TMO Set II works 14:00–21:40 hours.
- **Night Sets:** If a TMO functions in a night set, the set works throughout the night. Officials working on a particular night will not work the following night; a separate batch relieves them, and these batches work alternately.

Rule 11-A — Nodal Post Office

In important cities and towns, specific Post Offices are authorised to receive letters from neighbouring Post Offices and sort the mail according to a sorting diagram supplied by the RMS Superintendents.

- **Purpose:** To reduce peak-hour pressure in local sorting offices.
- **Designation:** Such offices are identified as Nodal Post Offices.

Rule 11-B — Central Bagging Unit (Kendriya Bagging Unit / KBU)

This unit is a branch of the RMS Office where bundles prepared by Post Offices or Mail Offices are grouped and enclosed in a **direct bag**. The workflow is:

1. Post Offices prepare bundles for various destinations (Post Offices, Districts, Circles or Mail Offices).
2. These bundles reach the Central Bagging Unit (KBU/CBU) in 'L' Bags or 'R' Bags.
3. The KBU/CBU opens these bags and groups the bundles by destination (e.g., Circle-wise, District-wise, PO-wise).
4. Bundles are then enclosed in the respective bags for the Post Office or Sorting Office concerned, for delivery or further transmission.

Rule 12 — Returned Letter Office (RLO)

A **Returned Letter Office (RLO)** — historically also called the Dead Letter Office — deals with unclaimed and refused articles, and articles without addresses or with undecipherable / incomplete addresses. It acts both as an *enquiry office* (to trace deliverable articles) and as the deposit office for genuinely undeliverable “returned” articles.

Retention: letters are generally retained for about **three months** in anticipation of a claim, after which they are destroyed; parcels and articles of value are held up to **one year** and then disposed of by public auction.

CURRENCY UPDATE — RLO Rationalisation

The earlier system of one RLO at every Circle Headquarters has been rationalised. Following Directorate orders in 2023 (reference: Mails/Misc/1/2023-D dated 21.08.2023 and connected orders), the RLO network was consolidated into FOUR Zonal RLOs covering the whole country. As part of this exercise, for example, the Delhi RLO was closed with effect from 01.10.2023 and its work mapped to the Northern Zone RLO at Lucknow.

Zone	Zonal RLO Location
Eastern	Kolkata
Western	Mumbai
Northern	Lucknow

Zone	Zonal RLO Location
Southern	Chennai

Rule 13 – International Mails and Exchange Offices

LEGISLATIVE NOTE

The provisions and the functional classification of Offices handling international mail were revised through Directorate communication in April 2022 (reference: provisions regarding Offices of Exchange amended on 04.04.2022). The four-fold classification below reflects that revised position, read with Customs notifications designating Foreign Post Offices.

1. Office of Exchange (OE)

- Makes up and exchanges international mails with Offices of Exchange of foreign countries after customs clearance.
- Can be an outward OE, an inward OE, or both.
- Maintains accounts relating to international mail exchange and handles enquiries / indemnity cases.

2. Office of Exchange of Transit

- Receives and dispatches only **closed mail bags** addressed to or received from OEs in India and foreign countries.
- Handles foreign-origin bags received in “Closed Transit” and forwards them to destination countries.
- Exchanges mail bags with carriers or officials of foreign administrations.

3. Foreign Post Office (FPO)

- An OE where Customs examination, assessment and clearance of imported / exported goods are carried out.
- Assessment of Customs Duty is done **only** for articles to be delivered within the jurisdiction of that FPO.
- Articles for other jurisdictions are diverted to the appropriate FPO for duty examination.
- Maintains accounts related to customs duty.

4. Sub-Foreign Post Office (SFPO)

- Receives and dispatches international mail (inbound / outbound) to and from mapped offices within the country.
- **No direct exchange** of mail with other countries.
- Conducts Customs examination of international mail assigned to the office and handles assessment / accounting of customs duty.

NOTE

A Sub-Foreign Post Office that is not yet equipped for customs assessment functions as an International Business Centre (IBC) until the customs facility commences. The export-oriented counterpart is the Dak Niryat Kendra (DNK).

Rule 14 — Transit Sections

Transit Sections are travelling offices of the Railway Mail Service working on railway or river-steamer lines.

- **Officer-in-Charge:** The officer in charge of a set is called a Mail Guard or Mail Agent (SA).
- **Designation:** Sections are numbered serially and designated by the name of the RMS Division followed by the serial number (e.g., DN-1).

Rule 15 — Mail Office

Mail Offices are stationary units of the RMS. Their classification and functions are distinct from Transit Mail Offices (TMOs):

Feature	Sorting Mail Office	Mail Office	Transit Mail Office (TMO)
Content handled	Contents of Ordinary L Bags	Contents of RL / SP / PL	Only closed bags
In-charge	Head Sorting Assistant	Head Sorting Assistant	Mail Agent (SA)
Designation	L1U or L2U	NSH / ICH / NPH / PH	MA

Nomenclature

- Mail offices located at railway stations are designated by the station name followed by “RMS” (e.g., Delhi RMS).
- Offices not located at stations are designated as Sorting Offices.

Rule 15-C — Press Sorting Office (PSO)

- **Location:** Situated on the premises of a newspaper.
- **Expenditure:** Wages and establishment costs are borne by the newspaper publisher, who also provides the necessary stationery.
- **Function:** Works to suit the dispatch timing of the newspaper and closes direct letter bags to Post Offices / Sorting Offices.
- **Paper Sorting Office:** Deals **only** with second-class articles such as newspapers, magazines and packets. It denotes L2S (e.g., PSO Gandhinagar).

Rules 15 & 18 — Record Offices

Administrative units responsible for work papers and staff matters:

Type	HRO (Head Record Office)	SRO (Sub-Record Office)	RO (Record Office)
Location	Headquarters of RMS Division	Same RMS Division (Non-HQ)	Same RMS Division (Non-HQ)
In-charge	Head Record Officer (HSG-I)	Sub Record Officer (LSG)	Record Officer (SA)
Functions	Keeps work papers of all offices at HQ; prepares salary / contingent bills for the entire division	Keeps work papers of all offices under its jurisdiction	Keeps work papers of sections attached to it

Rule 18-A — Bag Office

Units responsible for the management and accounting of bags:

Type	Unit Bag Office (UBO)	District Bag Office (DBO)	Circle Bag Office (CBO)
Entity	Every Post Office (except BOs)	HRO / SRO (exceptionally HO)	Postal Stores Depot
Function	Maintains Day Bag Book; submits daily bag balance to DBO	Maintains bag account for all types (category-wise) for Sorting Offices, TMOs and UBOs	Inspection of DBO / UBO; verification of balances; procurement, repair and auction of bags

NOTE

The “D” Section of the Postal Directorate functions as the Central Bag Office. It deals only with correspondence relating to the procurement and distribution of bags.

Rule 20 — Subsidiary Sorting Assistant

A Sorting Assistant who works within a Sorting Office for only a portion of its working hours, to assist a set where the work is heavy, is termed a Subsidiary Sorting Assistant.

Rule 21 — Sets (Section and Mail Office)

- **Numbering:** Sets are numbered serially. For sections, the serial number is preceded by the section name (e.g., A-26 / Set No. 4).
- **Uniformity:** Each set of the same section has the same working hours, the same number of officials and the same mail-exchange arrangement.
- **Determination:** The number of sets for a section is determined on the basis of weekly working hours.

Chapter 2 — Mail Operations and Bagging Procedures

This chapter covers how unregistered and registered articles are tied into bundles, how those bundles are enclosed in bags, and how the various bag types are classified. The **numerical thresholds** (how many articles make a bundle or warrant a separate bag) and the **check-slip colour codes** are heavily tested — commit them to memory.

Rule 24 — Labelled Bundles

Labelled bundles are collections of unregistered articles tied together with a check-slip. These are treated as “*not due*” items. The main types are:

- **Station Bundle:** Prepared when there are **15 or more** unregistered articles for a particular station.
- **Territorial Bundle:** Prepared for a specific state, a clearly-defined tract of country, or a foreign country when the number of articles is **25 or more**.
- **Sorting Bundle:** Contains unregistered articles for multiple stations.
- **Express Bundle:** Contains articles requiring immediate sorting upon receipt by the section.
- **Deferred Bundle:** Contains articles that can be disposed of later.

MEMORY AID — Bundle Thresholds

Station bundle = 15+ articles (one station). Territorial bundle = 25+ articles (a state / tract / foreign country). A quick way to remember: the wider the geography, the higher the threshold.

Rule 25 — Check Slip

A check-slip is a label tied to the top of each labelled bundle to identify its nature. The colour and any strip marking instantly tell a sorter what the bundle contains:

Colour Codes

Check-Slip Colour	Used For
Pink	Ordinary Station Paid and Unpaid bundles
White	Ordinary Sorting bundles (used for both express and deferred). For an Express Bundle, the white slip is further marked on the face with 2 diagonal lines in blue pencil

Check-Slip Colour	Used For
Blue	Foreign air-mail bundles (marked with the words “Air Mail”)

Strip Markings

Strip Colour	Indicates
Green strips	Local articles
Yellow strips	Rajdhani bundles
Blue strips	Metro bundles

Rule 25-A — Money Order Check-Slip

A specific check-slip (**M.O. 70**) printed in **red ink** on white or Badami (light-brown) paper is prescribed for preparing money-order bundles for dispatch.

Rule 26 — Mail Bags

Mail bags are categorised on the basis of their contents and destination:

5. Station Mail Bags
6. Sorting Mail Bags
7. Combined Mail Bags

NOTE

When a Cash Bag and a Register Bag are included inside a Mail Bag, the symbol “**F**” is marked on the label.

Rule 26-A — Airmail Bag

- **Definition:** A mail bag containing unregistered and registered articles to be carried by any air service under the “All-Up Scheme”.
- **Bag Type:** A blue dosuti bag should ordinarily be used.
- **Weight Limit:** The weight of an air-mail bag or air Transit Bag (TB) should not exceed **30 kg**.

Contents:

- The bag must not contain articles that are not intended for air carriage.
- **Nil contents:** if there are no articles for dispatch, a bag with 'nil' contents need not be closed; a suitable entry is made in the delivery bill.
- **Air covers:** if the number of articles is **less than 50** and there are no insured articles or air parcels, an air-mail cover of suitable size is used instead of a bag.
- **Air Parcels:** When an air parcel is enclosed, the bag label must bear the superscription "C.A.P".
- **Registered Articles:** Should not be enclosed in a bag unless their number **exceeds 25**, or they are bulky, or they accompany insured articles. Otherwise they are tied crosswise with the registered list and a check-slip marked 'REGISTERED'.

Rule 27 — Registered Bundle

A registered bundle is prepared when the number of registered articles is **greater than 2** (i.e., a **minimum of 3** articles).

Rule 28 — Registered Bag

- **Contents:** Contains the cash bag, ordinary and V.P. registered letters / packets, insured envelopes, registered / insured bundles, and money-order bundles, tied with a check-slip and a registered list.
- **Classification:** It is a **Due Bag**.
- **Cash Bag Procedure:** If a registered bag contains a cash bag, the enclosing mail-bag label is indicated by the symbol 'F'. The registered list bears the impression of the Treasury Date Stamp or Round MO Stamp.

Rule 29 — Insured Bundle

An insured bundle is prepared when the number of insured articles is **greater than 1** (i.e., a **minimum of 2** articles).

- **Dispatch:** Dispatched inside the registered bag with remarks in the registered list.
- **Separate Bag:** If the number of insured letters / bundles for a Mail Office usually exceeds **10**, a separate insured-letter bag may be prescribed as a separate due bag.

MEMORY AID — Bundle Minimums

Registered bundle = 3+ articles (more than 2). Insured bundle = 2+ articles (more than 1).
Separate insured bag if insured items usually exceed 10.

Rules 30 to 37-A — Classification of Bags

Bags are broadly classified into **“Due Bags”** (periodical / regular) and **“Unusual Bags”** (ad-hoc):

Due Bags (regular)	Unusual Bags (ad-hoc)
Transit Bag	Parcel Bag
Account Bag	Packet Bag
BO Bag	Cash Bag
Registered Bag	Special Bag
—	Camp Bag

Rules 40 & 41 — Operational Definitions

Term	Definition	Example
Changing Station	The point where the beats of two Transit Sections join.	Yoga Express (Haridwar–Ahmedabad): DN-1-Out ends at Delhi; J-3-IN starts from Delhi to Ajmer.
Connecting Section	An RMS section working in a train in immediate connection with another train containing another RMS section.	A-43 IN connecting with J-3 OUT.

Rules 46 & 47 — Orders

- **A Orders:** Issued by the Superintendent, RMS, prescribing changes in sorting lists.
- **B Orders:** Issued by the Superintendent, RMS, for guidance on all subjects except alterations in sorting lists.
 - **TB Orders:** the letter ‘T’ is prefixed to ‘B’ orders issued regarding camp articles and camp bags for high officials on tour.

Rule 52-A — Due Mails and Sorting List

- **Due Mail List:** Shows the details of bags to be received and dispatched by a Mail Office or Transit Section.

Sorting List shows:

8. The offices for which mail bags and registered bags are to be made up.
9. The offices to which parcel-mail articles may be sent direct, and the manner of dispatch.

Rule 56-A — Late and Too Late Letters

- **Late Letters:** Letters posted in a Post Office, Mail Office or letter box after the closing hour together with the prescribed late fee.
- **Too Late Letters:** Letters posted after the closing hour **without** the prescribed late fee.

CURRENCY UPDATE — Late Fee Abolished

The special late fee for late / window posting has been done away with. By Gazette notification G.S.R. 912(E) dated 29.12.2022, Rule 196 of the Indian Post Office Rules, 1933 was substituted so that any article presented at the window of a post office during prescribed hours is simply accepted for dispatch — without a separate late fee. The distinction between “late” and “too late” letters is therefore now of historical / academic interest only. (This position carries forward under the Post Office Regulations, 2024.)

Chapter 3 — General Rules and Procedures

This chapter gathers the operational rules that keep the mail moving accurately: trial cards, posting deadlines, stamping and postmark discipline, weight limits, and the registers in which irregularities are recorded. Watch for the **time-frames** and **weight figures** — these are classic objective-question material.

Rule 57-A — Trial Cards

Trial cards are service Post Cards (**M 26(a)**) used to determine the relative advantage of alternative mail routes, or to trace the cause of detention to articles.

Format — a trial card carries the following columns on the back:

10. Source of receipt
 11. Remarks, misconnection, etc.
 12. Manner of disposal
 13. Date stamp of the office or section
 14. Signature of the Head Sorting Assistant / Postmaster / Supervisor
- **Disposal:** It is returned in a service cover to the issuing officer and should **not** be included in any station bundle.

Rule 58 — Latest Hours for Posting

Category	Latest Hour for Posting
Night Mails	Ordinarily 6 p.m.
Day Mails	Thirty minutes before the hour fixed for closing the mail
Railway Forwarding	Mails should ordinarily reach the station 10 minutes before the train's arrival

Rule 59 — Clearance of Letter Boxes

Letter boxes of a Post Office or Mail Office should be cleared at convenient intervals during the day so that dispatch preparation can be expedited.

Rules 74 & 75 — Bag Classifications

Feature	Plural Mail Bag	Extra Mail Bag
Category	Due Bag	Unusual Bag
Usage	Used as a Registered bag	Used as an Unregistered bag

Rule 76/2 — Inland Air-Mail Delivery

- **Documentation:** **Six copies** of the inland air-mail delivery bills [M-57, M-57(a), M-57(b)] must be prepared for each port of call.

Distribution of the six copies:

15. 1st copy — sent to the Air Mail Accounts Section of the Postal Directorate.
16. 4 copies — handed over to the Air Carrier Agent along with the mails.
17. Office copy — retained with the work papers, bearing the Agent's receipt signature.

Rule 85 — Distinguishing Marks

Certain numbers must be preceded by distinguishing letters so their nature is unmistakable:

Article / Bundle	Distinguishing Mark
Insured articles	"Ins"
V.P. articles	"V.P."
Registered / Insured bundles	"R.B." or "I.B."
Postal Service registered articles	Cipher "O"

Rules 103 & 103-A — Postmarks and Seals

- **Custody:** Impressions of round / oblong money-order stamps and unpaid stamps are kept in a separate book of postmarks under the Postmaster's personal custody.
- **Cleaning:** The cleansing of seals and stamps must be recorded daily — in the Postmaster's Order Book (HO), the Error Book (SO), or the Rough Notebook (RMS).

Rule 107 — Stamping Rules

- **Two stamps:** Defaced by a single impression so the date stamp covers both, with the greater portion falling on the cover.

- **Blocks:** For a block of four stamps (square shape), one neat impression at the centre suffices.
- **Foreign articles:** If stamps on inward foreign articles were not cancelled by the office of origin, they should **not** be date-stamped; instead, cancel them with a thick stroke in ink or indelible pencil.

Rule 111-A — Foreign Postage Deficiency

Offices of Exchange must impress a **“T” stamp** on the middle-upper front of unpaid / insufficiently-paid articles. The amount equal to **twice the deficient postage** must be written in legible figures.

Rule 135 — Weight Limits for Mails

These limits cap the load that a runner, carrier or postman may carry. They are among the most frequently asked figures in objective papers:

Carrier / Type	Maximum Weight
Letter Mail Runner (Main Line)	14 kg
Parcel Bag (RMS Trolley)	37 kg
Postman / Village Postman	10 kg (includes parcels / cash)
Special Parcel Runner	14 kg per parcel (max 28 kg per man)

Rule 136 — Supply of Due Mail & Sorting Lists (M-9)

- **Post Offices (direct RMS communication):** Supplied by the Superintendent of the RMS Division.
- **Other Offices:** Supplied by the Superintendent of Post Offices.
- **Village Sorting Lists (M-52):** Prepared and supplied to HO / SO / BO by the Sub-Division Head.

Rule 145 — Record of Irregularities

Office / Official	Register Maintained
Post Offices	Error Book
RMS Sorting Assistants	Rough Notebook

Rule 147 — Interception of Letters

Under the departmental procedure of the Manual, interception requires orders from the **Member (O)**, the **Head of Circle**, or the **Regional Head**.

- **Emergency:** The Divisional Head may order interception but must inform the competent authority within **3 days**. Confirmation must be obtained within **7 days**, failing which the action ceases.

CURRENCY UPDATE — Statutory Basis of Interception

Interception of postal items is now governed by Section 9 of the Post Office Act, 2023, read with Rules 16–18 of the Post Office Rules, 2024. The grounds are: security of the

State, friendly relations with foreign states, public order, emergency, public safety, or contravention of any law. Under Rule 16(11), the directions for interception and detention remain in force — unless revoked earlier — for a period not exceeding 30 days, extendable, but not beyond 90 days; thereafter the detained item is handed to the law-enforcement authority. The Manual's 3-day / 7-day departmental procedure continues as internal practice to the extent not inconsistent with this statutory scheme.

Rule 148 — Redelivery and Address Alteration

- **Fee:** A fee of ₹6/- applies for recalling an item or altering the address / addressee name without the addressee's consent (the corresponding fee for international items is ₹30/-).
- **Free alteration:** The addressee may alter the address **free of charge** if the new address is within the delivery area of the same Post Office.

LEGISLATIVE NOTE

This facility is now codified in Regulation 57 of the Post Office Regulations, 2024: a sender may recall an accountable domestic item (or international inward item) or alter the address / addressee name on payment of the prescribed fee, without the addressee's consent; and the addressee may have the address altered free of charge where the old and new addresses fall within the same post office's delivery area. The ₹6 domestic fee remains current.

Rule 155 — Half-Yearly Enumeration Returns

- **Period:** Conducted during the second week of **February** and **August** (from the **8th to the 21st**, both days inclusive).
- **Submission:** A copy of the return must be forwarded by the **15th day** to the Head of Circle (by HOs) or to the Head Office (by SOs).

Chapter 4 — Investigation and Weighment

This chapter deals with how the Department investigates offences (loss, fraud, theft) and how bags conveyed by rail are weighed for charging. The **monetary limits** deciding who investigates, and the **weighment dates**, are the high-yield points here.

Rule 172-A — Investigation of Offences

LEGISLATIVE NOTE — New Criminal Laws

With effect from 01.07.2024, the Code of Criminal Procedure, 1973 (CrPC) has been replaced by the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023 (BNSS). All section references below have been updated to the BNSS. The corresponding substantive law is the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023 (replacing the IPC), and the evidence law is the Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam, 2023.

- **Cognizable cases (e.g., robbery, theft):** Once information is given to the Police under the provision corresponding to Section 154 CrPC — now **Section 173 BNSS** — action is controlled by the Police.
- **Non-cognizable cases (e.g., forgery):** Departmental investigation must begin immediately. If police aid is required, the matter is placed before a Magistrate under the provision corresponding to Section 155 CrPC — now **Section 174 BNSS**.

MEMORY AID

Old → New: Section 154 CrPC → **Section 173 BNSS** (cognizable / FIR). Section 155 CrPC → **Section 174 BNSS** (non-cognizable).

Rule 175 — Monetary Limits for Investigation

The authority competent to handle loss and fraud cases depends on the principal amount involved. The current limits were notified by the Directorate with effect from 23/24.09.2021:

Level of Investigating Officer	Monetary Limit (w.e.f. 23.09.2021)
Inspector / ASPOs	Up to ₹2 lakh
Divisional Head / Chief or Senior PM	Above ₹2 lakh up to ₹5 lakh
AD / APMG (Regional / Circle Office)	Above ₹5 lakh up to ₹10 lakh

Level of Investigating Officer	Monetary Limit (w.e.f. 23.09.2021)
Director Postal Services & above	Above ₹10 lakh

NOTE

The limit is based on the principal amount of loss / fraud (including temporary misappropriation); normal and penal interest are excluded when fixing the investigating authority. Only loss / fraud cases where the amount involved exceeds ₹10 lakh are now reported by the Circle to the Directorate (raised from the earlier ₹5 lakh threshold). Separately, under Rule 34 of GFR, 2017, all losses above ₹50,000 due to suspected fire, theft or fraud are to be reported to the Police.

Rule 226 — Weighment System

A system on Indian Railways under which closed bags are conveyed in luggage vans **without a weight limit**.

- **Charges:** Mails are charged by weight.
- **Payment:** Half-yearly for a regular daily service; quarterly for occasional dispatches.

Rule 234 — Half-Yearly Weighment of Bags

- **Dates:** Weighment is conducted on **21st January** and **21st July** of each year.

Procedure — a statement in **Form M-105** is prepared in quadruplicate:

- Original & Duplicate — handed to the Stationmaster.
- Triplicate — forwarded to the Superintendent, RMS.
- Quadruplicate — retained as the office copy with the work papers.

MEMORY AID — Two “21st” Dates

Half-yearly weighment of bags = 21 January & 21 July. Do not confuse these with the half-yearly enumeration returns (Rule 155), which run 8–21 February and 8–21 August.

Quick Revision — High-Yield Facts

A last-mile recap of the most frequently tested numbers and facts in this volume. Cover the right column and test yourself.

Key Numbers

Point	Value
Station bundle threshold	15 or more articles
Territorial bundle threshold	25 or more articles
Registered bundle	More than 2 (min 3) articles
Insured bundle	More than 1 (min 2) articles
Air-mail bag / TB weight limit	30 kg
Air cover instead of bag	Fewer than 50 articles (no insured / air parcel)
Registered articles enclosed in bag only if	More than 25 (or bulky / with insured)
Letter Mail Runner (main line)	14 kg
Parcel Bag (RMS Trolley)	37 kg
Postman / Village Postman	10 kg
Special Parcel Runner	14 kg/parcel; 28 kg/man
Foreign postage deficiency mark	“T” stamp; twice the deficiency
Recall / address-alteration fee (domestic)	₹6/- (international ₹30/-)
Inland air-mail delivery bill copies	6 copies
Half-yearly weighment of bags	21 Jan & 21 Jul
Half-yearly enumeration returns	8–21 Feb & 8–21 Aug
Interception (statutory) max period	30 days; extendable up to 90 days
Loss/fraud reporting to Directorate	Above ₹10 lakh
Police reporting threshold (GFR 2017)	Above ₹50,000

Key Designations (In-Charge)

Office	In-Charge
Head Record Office (HRO)	Head Record Officer (HSG-I)
Sub-Record Office (SRO)	Sub Record Officer (LSG)
Record Office (RO)	Record Officer (SA)
Transit Mail Office (TMO)	Mail Agent / Mail Guard
Sorting / Mail Office	Head Sorting Assistant
Transit Section (set)	Mail Guard / Mail Agent (SA)

Key Framework Dates

Instrument	In Force From
Post Office Act, 2023	18 June 2024
Post Office Rules, 2024 (G.S.R. 767(E))	16 December 2024
Post Office Regulations, 2024 (S.O. 5440(E))	16 December 2024
BNSS / BNS / BSA, 2023 (new criminal laws)	1 July 2024
Late fee abolished (G.S.R. 912(E))	29 December 2022
Investigation monetary limits revised	23/24 September 2021
RLO rationalised to 4 Zonal RLOs	2023 (e.g., Delhi RLO closed 01.10.2023)

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